UNIVERSITY OF GHANA

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DEPARTMENT OF TEACHER EDUCATION

SCHOOL OF EDUCATION AND LEADERSHIP

END OF SECOND SEMESTER EXAMINATION, 2024/2025

(B. ED) JHS SPECIALISM

COURSE CODE: TEJS 218

COURSE TITLE: STUDIES IN PROSE, DRAMA AND POETRY

DURATION: 2 HOURS

SECTION A

[25 marks]

Instruction: Answer all the questions from this section.

1. Imagine a writer describing a piece of literature as "an overflow of emotion." Which literary form is most likely being described?
   a. prose
   b. drama
   c. poetry
   d. epic

2. Lusophone poets, writing from Portuguese-speaking Africa, often explored themes unique to their cultural background. A common feature of Lusophone poetry is the ….
   a. admiration of nature
   b. belief in ancestral spirits
   c. belief in one true God
   d. chanting

3. During the 20th century, African writers engaged in movements that shaped literature. One of the following is an ideal of the Negritude movement.

a. Fostering world unity
b. Promoting black consciousness
c. Instituting African leadership
d. Promoting rebellion

4. After devastating global events, certain philosophies became dominant in literature. Which of these events may have likely influenced the belief in existentialism?

a. World war 1
b. World war 2
c. September 11th attack
d. Persian wars

5. In literary studies, poems are sometimes classified by length and structure. A poem of fourteen lines with a regular rhyme pattern is called….

a. an epic
b. an elegy
c. a sonnet
d. a ballad

6. In tragedies such as Shakespeare's *Othello* or Sophocles' *Oedipus Rex*, the downfall of the hero is often attributed to something within themselves. In a tragedy, the hero falls to ruin as a result of ….

a. a flaw
b. a vision
c. an obstruction
d. a villain

7. In Albert Camus' *The Stranger*, Meursault rejects the priest's offer of prayer before his execution. Meursault's refusal of the priest's prayer is an idea of ….

a. carpe diem
b. existentialism
c. essentialism
d. capitalism

Use the extract below to answer questions 8 to 11:

"The scarecrow is here. Begone fop! This is the world of women. At this moment our star sits in the centre of the world. We are supreme".

8. Whose words are these?

a. Lakunle
b. Sadiku
c. Sidi
d. Baroka

9. Who is the "scarecrow"?
   a. Lakunle
   b. Baroka
   c. Sadiku
   d. Sidi

10. Who else was present when the utterance was made?
   a. Baroka
   b. The girls
   c. Sidi
   d. Court messenger

11. What were the women going to do?
   a. Perform a ritual bath
   b. Perform a dance
   c. Sing for the moon
   d. Talk about the king

12. A poet once wrote: *There was painful laughter on the metallic hell of the roads.* "Painful laughter" in this expression involves the use of ....
   a. Irony
   b. Oxymoron
   c. Imagery
   d. Sarcasm

13. In describing someone, a writer says: *He looked at me vaguely as drinking cattle do*. The literary device employed in this line is ...
   a. Metaphor
   b. Imagery
   c. Simile
   d. Hyperbole

Use the extract below to answer questions 14 to 16:
"Then there was sleep. At first, I didn't sleep well at night and not at all during the day. Little by little, my nights got better and I was able to sleep during the day."

14. Where is the speaker?
   a. At his mother's funeral
   b. In his room in Algiers
   c. In prison
   d. In the court room

15. Why could the speaker not sleep well at first?
   a. The speaker had a lot of things to do.
   b. The speaker was thinking about his mother.
   c. The speaker has missed his friends.
   d. The speaker was worried about his condition.

16. Who is the person identified as "I" in the extract?
   a. Marie
   b. Raymond
   c. Meursault
   d. Perez

17. In Koramma's *Valiant Owusu*, the person addressed has ....
   a. travelled
   b. lost his job
   c. moved to another town
   d. died

18. The line, *The rover, whose footprints are on all paths*, illustrates the use of ...
   a. Soliloquy
   b. Assonance
   c. Rhythm
   d. Hyperbole

19. Which of these characters in *The Stranger* never set foot on the beach?
   a. Raymond
   b. Marie
   c. Salamano
   d. Meursault

20. The sequence of events in a story is called....
   a. Setting
   b. Characterization
   c. Plot
   d. Epilogue

Use the extract below to answer questions 21 to 24:
"How irritable I have grown of late. Such doubts to harbour of your loyalty. But this disaster is too much for one checked thus as I upon the prime of youth".

21. Who is this irritable person in the extract?
   a. Lakunle
   b. Baroka
   c. Sidi
   d. Sadiku

22. Whose loyalty is being doubted?
   a. Baroka
   b. Sidi
   c. Lakunle
   d. Sadiku

23. What disaster does the speaker lament?
   a. loss of money
   b. loss of his manhood
   c. loss of his wife
   d. ill health

24. The speech above illustrates ….
   a. Irony
   b. Soliloquy
   c. Sarcasm
   d. Mime

25. "*Was it cowardice that I dared not kill him?*" This expression involves the use of …
   a. Sarcasm
   b. Dialogue
   c. Monologue
   d. Rhetorical question

SECTION B

[75 marks]

Answer any **three** questions, **one** from each genre

Drama

1. In Wole Soyinka's *The Lion and the Jewel*, Lakunle stands out as a symbol of modernity, representing Western education and values within a traditional African society. His ideals often clash with the village customs and influence the choices of other characters, particularly Sidi and Baroka. Comment on the importance of Lakunle to the development of the plot.

2. *The Lion and the Jewel* not only entertains but also reflects African society by presenting cultural practices, beliefs, and values. Through characters, dialogue, and conflict, Soyinka explores themes of marriage, leadership, respect for elders, and the clash between tradition and modernity. Comment on African traditional values presented in *The Lion and the Jewel.*

Poetry

3. D.H. Lawrence's poem *Snake* captures the poet's encounter with a snake at a water trough, raising questions about fear, power, and respect for nature. The poem presents the snake as majestic yet dangerous, creating tension between cultural teachings and personal admiration. Examine the theme of power in *Snake.*

4. David Diop's poem *The Vultures* is often read within the framework of the Negritude movement, which sought to affirm African identity, heritage, and resilience against colonial oppression. The poem uses imagery of vultures to comment on both destruction and survival, reflecting the struggles of African people. Discuss *The Vultures* as a Negritude poem.

Prose

5. In Albert Camus' *The Stranger*, Meursault is often regarded as an outsider whose indifference to social norms, emotions, and morality sets him apart. His alienation becomes evident in his response to his mother's death, his relationship with Marie, and his trial. Examine the attributes which make Meursault "the stranger" of human society.

6. Camus' *The Stranger* embodies the existentialist philosophy of embracing the present moment in a meaningless world. Through Meursault's actions, we see instances where he lives for immediate experiences without concern for the future or societal judgment. Discuss any four instances of *carpe diem* (seize the moment) in the novel.